

Qin Li, Ph.D.

Postdoctoral Fellow

Department of Communication, University of Missouri

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Academic Appointments

2024 – **Postdoctoral Fellow**, Department of Communication, University of Missouri
present

Education

- 2019 – 2024 **Ph.D.**, Communication, The Ohio State University
Dissertation: “In people we trust: The effect of trust and network closure on factual beliefs and misinformation sharing” (**Lynda Lee Kaid Outstanding Dissertation Award**)
Advisors: Dr. R. Kelly Garrett, Dr. Robert M. Bond
- 2017 – 2019 **M.A.**, Communication, Washington State University
- 2013 – 2017 **B.A.** Journalism (with honors), Fudan University
Specialization: Information Science and Technology

Peer-reviewed Journals

denotes shared first-authorship where two authors contribute equally to a publication.

* denotes graduate student co-author at the time of submission.

9. **Li, Q.**, Warner, B., & Madrigal, G. (Forthcoming). “They’re eating the dogs, they’re eating the cats:” Presidential Debates as a Megaphone for Identity-based Disinformation *International Journal of Communication*.
8. **#Li, Q.**, **#Bond**, R. M., Dixon, G. N., Hovick, S. R., Na, K., Nisbet, C. E., Wegener, D. T., & Garrett, R. K. (Forthcoming). The limited effect of social media use on political and health misperceptions: Evidence from digital trace data and panel surveys. *PLOS ONE*.
7. Bond, R. M., **Li, Q.**, Nisbet, E. C., & Garrett, R. K. (Accepted). Rallying the base, corroding the truth: Elite communication, misperceptions, and the communication of democratic decline. *Political Communication*.
6. **Li, Q.** (2026). Is it just about the facts? The case for a critical, pro-democracy approach to information integrity. *Journal of Applied Communication Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00909882.2025.2573951>

5. Warner, B., **Li, Q.**, *Gillespie, B., *de Braganca Peixoto, J., Winfrey, & K. Madrigal, G. (2026). Race and gender politics in the podcast sphere and their consequences. *Journal of Radio and Media Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19376529.2026.2613209>
4. **Li, Q.**, Bond, R. M., & Garrett, R. K. (2023). Misperceptions in Sociopolitical Context: Belief Sensitivity's Relationship with Battleground State Status and Partisan Segregation. *Journal of Communication*. 73(5), 439-451, <https://doi.org/10.1093/joc/jqad017>
3. **Li, Q.**, Hassel, H. J., & Bond, R. M. (2023). Journalists' networks: Homophily and peering over the shoulder of other journalists. *PLOS ONE*. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0291544>
2. Li, Y., Wang, Z., & **Li, Q.** (2023). Presidential communication during the pandemic: a longitudinal examination of its relationship with partisan perceptions and behaviors in the United States. *Human Communication Research*. 49(4), 433-447. <https://doi.org/10.1093/hcr/hqad025>
1. Nisbet, E. C., Mortenson, C., & **Li, Q.** (2021). The presumed influence of election misinformation on others reduces our own satisfaction with democracy. *Harvard Kennedy School (HKS) Misinformation Review*. <https://doi.org/10.37016/mr-2020-59>

Book Chapters

2. **Li, Q.** (2026). Not all falsehoods are equal: A critical examination of mis- and disinformation during the 2024 U.S. presidential Election. In B. R. Warner, D. G. Bystrom, M. S. McKinney, & M. C. Banwart (Eds.), *Democracy on the line: The turbulent 2024 presidential election*.
1. Winfrey, K. L., *de Braganca Peixoto, J., **Li, Q.**, Madrigal, G., Warner, B. (2026). From Playboys to Cat Ladies: Masculinity and Gender in the 2024 Presidential Election. In B. R. Warner, D. G. Bystrom, M. S. McKinney, & M. C. Banwart (Eds.), *Democracy on the line: The turbulent 2024 presidential election*.

Work Under Review

1. **Li, Q.**, *Wippell, J., *Hunt, J., Yadon, N., Bond, R. M., & Tien, J. (Abstract accepted; manuscript under review). How social media foster expression of alternative identities and narratives about race: A multi-platform analysis of online right-wing communities using BERT and Structural Topic Modeling. *Political Psychology*.

Grant Experience

2025 "A New Measurement Science for the Evaluation of AI Systems"
 Funder: University of Missouri Big Ideas Grant (\$75,000; **Funded**)
 PI/co-PIs: Behm-Morawitz, E. (Communication), & Davis-Stober, C. (Psychology)
 Role: Collaborator

- 2025 “Evaluating AI Systems’ Ability to Measure Value-laden Concepts”
Funder: OpenAI Researcher Access Program (\$1,000; Submitted)
Role: Principal Investigator
- 2025 “Toward a Theoretical and Empirical Understanding of Epistemic Risks of and Epistemic Trust in AI in Communication Science.” (\$240,000; Unfunded)
Funder: The Sloan Foundation
Role: Principal Investigator
- 2024 “Structured network science approach to monitoring online discourse about race.”
PI/co-PIs: Tien, J., Bond, R. M., & Yadon, N.
Role: Research assistant (*Data management, cleaning, and analysis*)
Funder: Translational Data Analytics Institute, The Ohio State University
- 2020 - 2023 “RAPID: Quantifying the Downstream Effects of COVID-19 Online Health Information on Risk Perceptions, Decision Making, Policy Preferences, and Preventive Health Behaviors.”
PI/co-PIs: Nisbet, E. C., Bond, R. M., Dixon, G., Garrett, R. K., Hovick, S., Na, K., & Wegener, D. T.
Funder: National Science Foundation
Role: Research assistant (*Data management, cleaning, and analysis*)
- 2020 - 2023 “Quantifying Harms of Misinformation during the U.S. Presidential Election.”
PI/co-PIs: Nisbet, E. C., Bond, R. M., & Garrett, R. K.
Funder: Facebook
Role: Research Assistant (*Data management, cleaning, and analysis*)

Awards and grants

- 2026 Postdoc Teaching Award, University of Missouri
- 2025 Lynda Lee Kaid Outstanding Dissertation Award, Political Communication Division, National Communication Association (NCA)
- 2025 MU Postdoctoral Association Travel Award, University of Missouri
- 2024 GitHub Student Developer Program Award, GitHub
- 2024 School of Communication Peer Award, The Ohio State University
- 2019-2024 School of Communication Research Grant (\$8,000), The Ohio State University
- 2019 Graduate School Fellowship (\$26,316), The Ohio State University

- 2018 Graduate and Professional Student Association Travel Grant, Washington State University
- 2018 Murrow College Brelsford Scholarship, Washington State University
- 2018 Murrow College Travel Grant, Washington State University
- 2018 Student Travel Award, International Communication Association

Conference Presentations

17. **Li, Q.**, Warner, B., & Madrigal, G. (Accepted). "Identity-based discourse on social media during an election: Evidence from X/Twitter and survey data." *National Communication Association, Political Communication Division*.
16. Warner, B., **Li, Q.**, Gillespie, B., de Braganca Peixoto, J., Winfrey, K., & Madrigal, G. (Accepted). "Race and gender politics in the podcast sphere and their consequences." *National Communication Association, Political Communication Division*.
15. **#Li, Q.**, *Wippell, J., *Hunt, J., Yadon, N., Bond, R. M., & Tien, J. (2026). How online social networks foster expression of alternative identities and narratives about race: A cross-platform analysis of right-leaning online communities using BERT model and Structural Topic Modeling, *American Political Science Association 2026 Annual Meeting, Political Communication Preconference*, Boston, MA.
14. *Gaw, F., **Li, Q.**, Bond, R. M., Garrett, R. K., & Nisbet, E. (2026). "Social Media, Metaperceptions, and Political Violence in the 2024 Election," *American Political Science Association 2026 Annual Meeting*, Boston, MA.
13. Flanagan, W., Mortenson, C., & **Li, Q.** (2026). Political Divergence of AI: Large Language Models' Perspectives on Democracy. *American Political Science Association 2026 Annual Meeting*, Boston, MA.
12. **Li, Q.**, Dai, Y., & Koncilja, K. (2026). "Measuring Anti-democratic (Dis)information Flows Using Large language Models (LLMs)," *American Political Science Association 2026 Annual Meeting, Virtual Meeting*.
11. **Li, Q.**, Dai, Y., & Koncilja, K. (2026). "Measuring Anti-democratic (Dis)information Flows Using Human-centered Artificial Intelligence (AI) Method," *Comm Horizons @ UCD 2026: Communication in the Age of AI and Algorithms*, Davis, CA.
10. **Li, Q.** (2025). "Candidates as a source of mis- and disinformation during the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election," presented at *National Communication Association 110th Annual Convention*, Denver, CO.
9. **Li, Q.** (2025). "In People We Trust: How Dyadic Trust Impacts Factual Beliefs and (Mis)information Sharing," presented at *International Communication Association 75th Annual Conference, Division of Political Communication*, Denver, CO.
8. **Li, Q.** (2023). "In people we trust: the effect of political homophily and network closure on factual beliefs," presented at *National Communication Association 109th Annual Convention, Division of Political Communication*, National Harbor, MD.

7. Bond, R. M., **Li, Q.**, Nisbet, E. C., & Garrett, R. K. (2022). "The effect of campaign rallies on misperceptions," presented at *The 5th Annual Conference of Politics and Computational Social Science*, Boston, MA.
6. **Li, Q.**, Bond, R. M., & Garrett, R. K. (2022). "Misperceptions in the sociopolitical context: Effects of battleground state status and partisan segregation," presented at *International Communication Association 72th Annual Conference, Division of Political Communication*.
5. Li, Y., Wang, Z., & **Li, Q.** (2021). "White House Communication and Its Impact on the Public during the Pandemic," presented at *International Communication Association 71st Annual Conference*.
4. **Li, Q.** (2018). "Political Conservatism and Media Effect of Strategic Framing: Evidence from China," presented at *2018 American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting*, Political Communication Pre-Conference, Boston, MA.
3. Daud, I., **Li, Q.**, Wang, M., Borah, P. & Himelboim, I. (2018). "Campaign strategies on Twitter in 2016 U.S. presidential election: Real-time event, negativity, and online engagement," presented at *2018 Annual Conference of the Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)*, Division of Political Communication, Washington, DC.
2. Wang, M., Borah, P., **Li, Q.**, & Himelboim, I. (2018). "Twitter strategies used during the 2016 U.S. presidential election: Donald Trump and Mike Pence vs. Hillary Clinton and Tim Kaine," presented at *2018 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Division of Communication Technology, Prague, Czech Republic.
1. Liu, X., **Li, Q.**, & Chang, C-W. (2017). "Discussion with weak ties and perceived political agreement among Chinese youth: A mediation approach," presented at *2017 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Digital Asia Pre-Conference, San Diego, CA.

Invited Talks

Research

Qin Li, Presenter. 2026. How Social Media Contribute to Misperceptions and Identity-based Participation, University of South Florida.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2023. The Limited Effect of Social Media Use on Political and Health Misperceptions: Evidence from Panel Surveys and Behavioral Data. Center for Social Media and Politics, New York University.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2023. Within and Beyond Social Media: The Information Environment and Factual Beliefs. College of Information & Department of Political Science, University of Maryland, College Park.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2020. Introduction to Web Scraping Using Python and R. Computational Research Methods Group, School of Journalism and Mass Communication, University of Wisconsin-Madison.

Professional Development

Qin Li, Panelist. 2025. Proseminar Panel on Campus Interviews. Department of Communication, University of Missouri.

Qin Li, Panelist. 2025. Proseminar Panel on Zoom Interviews. Department of Communication, University of Missouri.

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching

Political Communication (PhD-level), University of Missouri	Fall 2025
Instructor of record (Average SEI: 4.85-5.0/5.0)	

Undergraduate Teaching

Political Communication (in-person), University of Missouri	Fall 2026
Instructor of record	
Intro to Communication Technology (online, asynchronous), Ohio State University	Summer 2024
Instructor of record (Average SEI: 4.7/5.0)	
Industry Research Methods (in-person), Ohio State University	Fall 2022, Fall 2023
Instructor of record (Average SEI: 4.6-4.7/5.0)	
Multimedia Content Creation (hybrid), Washington State University	Fall 2018, Spring 2019
Lab Instructor	
Media and Society, Washington State University	Fall 2016, Spring 2017
Teaching Assistant	
Communication and Global Contexts, Washington State University	Fall 2016, Spring 2017
Teaching Assistant	

Guest Lecture

Introduction to Communication Theory (PhD-level), University of Missouri	Fall 2025
Lecture on Theory Construction in Political Misinformation Research	

Specialized Teaching Training

July 2024	CIRTL @ Ohio State Associate Endorsement, Michael V. Drake Institute for Teaching and Learning, The Ohio State University
September 2023	Inclusive Teaching Endorsement, Michael V. Drake Institute for Teaching and Learning, The Ohio State University

Service

Department Service

- 2026 – present – Colloquium Committee, Department of Communication, University of Missouri
- 2024 – 2026 – Research Committee, Department of Communication, University of Missouri
- 2024 – present – Faculty Co-organizer, Political Communication Institute (PCI), Department of Communication, University of Missouri
- 2024 – present – Faculty Member, International Teaching Assistant Support Group, Department of Communication, University of Missouri
- 2022 – 2024 – Treasurer, School of Communication Graduate Student Association, The Ohio State University
- 2023 – Organizer, Graduate Student Summer Writing Group, School of Communication, The Ohio State University
- 2021 – 2022 – Graduate Representative, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee, School of Communication, The Ohio State University
- 2018 – 2019 – Secretary, Graduate Student Association, Murrow College of Communication, Washington State University

Ad-hoc Journal Review

- Human Communication Research (2025) - 1
- Political Behavior (2024) - 1
- International Journal of Communication (2024) - 1
- Mass Communication and Society (2024) - 1

Conference Review

- International Communication Association Annual Conference:
 - Political Communication Division (2021, 2024, 2025);
 - Computational Methods Division (2024, 2025);
 - Communication Technology Division (2024)
- National Communication Association Annual Conference:
 - Political Communication Division (2026)

Mentorship in the Department

- 2025 – 2026 Mentor of Undergraduate Students (Lucy Berger, Andrew Mueller, Natalie Schaefer), Department of Communication, University of Missouri
- 2021, 2023 Peer Mentor, School of Communication, The Ohio State University

Mentorship in the Field

- 2025 Peer Mentor, Division of Political Communication, International Communication Association

Specialized Training

- Jun 2023 Implicit Bias Certificate, Kirwan Institute for the Study of Race & Ethnicity, The Ohio State University

Professional Affiliations

International Communication Association
National Communication Association
American Political Science Association

Research groups

- 2024 – Media & Diversity Center (MDC), Department of Communication, University of Missouri present
- 2023 – 2024 Violence, Ideology, and Extremism Working Group (VIEW), Mershon Center, The Ohio State University
- 2022 – 2024 Computational and Statistical Models (COSMOS) Group, Department of Communication, The Ohio State University

Skills

R, Python, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics, OTree, NetLogo, Heroku, SAS, Stata

References

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